

Software Tool Comparison

Power BI vs. Tableau

Power BI is the stronger primary accounting analytics tool.

Tableau remains valuable for visual exploration and leadership-facing dashboards.

Final recommendation

Adopt Microsoft Excel Power Query/Power BI as the main tool for accounting data preparation, audit analytics, and controlled reporting; use Tableau as a supplemental visualization tool when polished dashboards are needed.

Audience

Department head first; leadership team summary at the end.

Evidence

Course labs: Lending Club, Slainte duplicate payments, job costs, variance, and scorecard KPIs.

How I framed the data story

Purpose -> evidence -> conclusion -> leadership action

Story triangle used for the final project

Purpose

Choose the tool that best supports accounting analytics and decision making.

Events

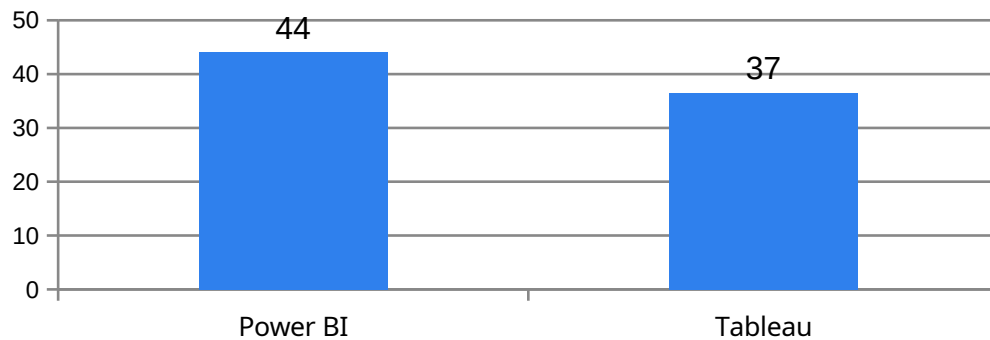
Cleaning, summaries, clusters, duplicate payments, job costs, variance, dashboards, KPIs.

Conclusion

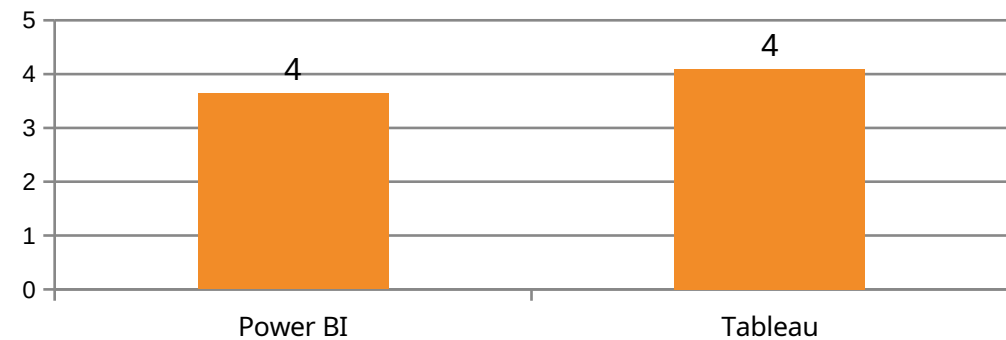
Power BI is the better primary tool; Tableau is the better presentation supplement.

Comparison metrics from the evaluation checklist

Time required by tool



Ease of use rating



Source: ACC 430 Evaluation Checklist, final workbook; Vora (2019) story triangle and audience-focused data storytelling principles.

Evidence base: what was tested

The comparison is based on course lab work, not opinion alone

Power Query / Power BI



Power BI evidence

Power Query profiling, summary statistics, dashboards, DAX measures, duplicate-payment rules, job-cost and KPI visuals.

Tableau

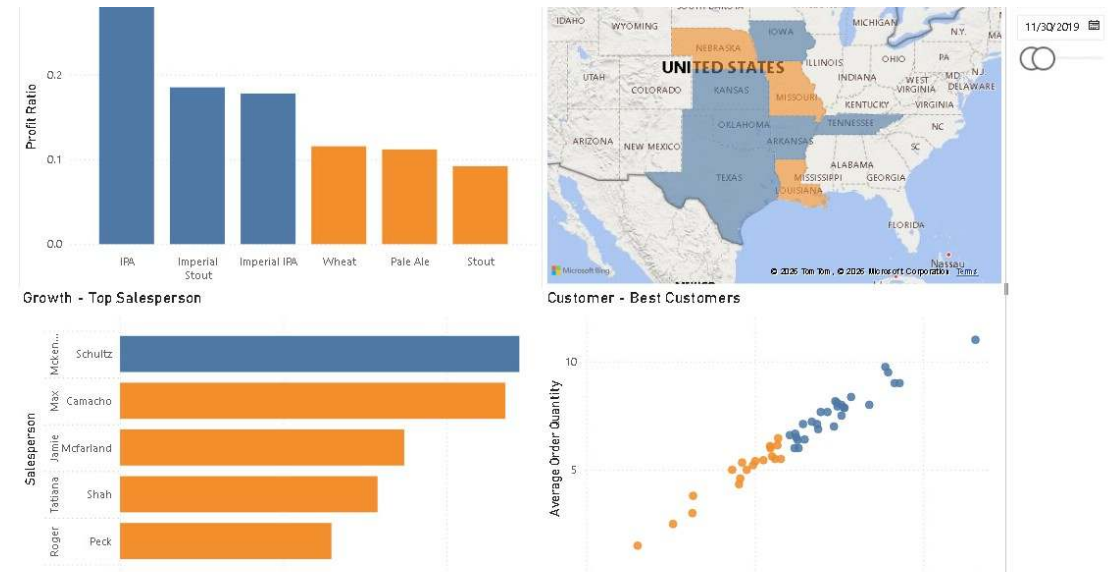
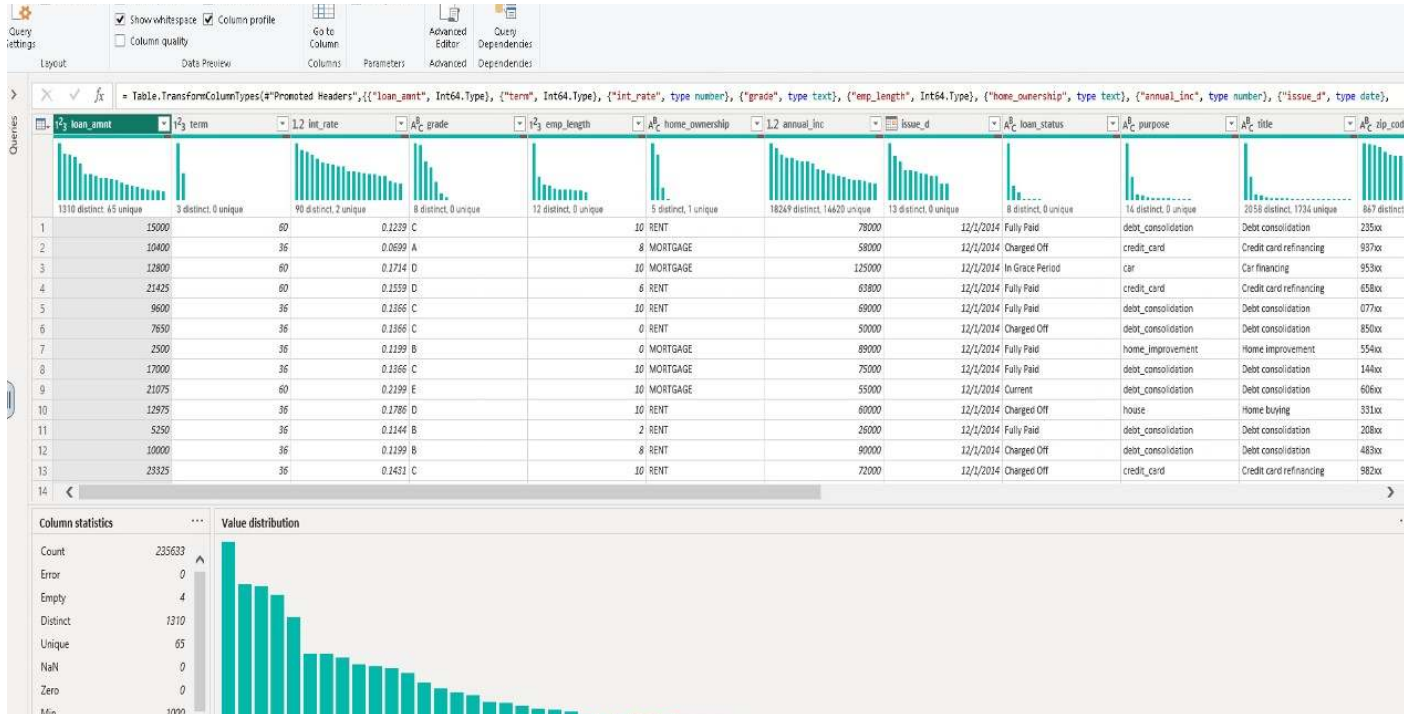


Tableau evidence

Clusters, filters, calculated fields, map views, stacked bars, scorecard dashboards, and leadership-ready visuals.

Power BI: stronger preparation and traceability

Accounting analytics begins with clean, defensible data



Why this matters

Power Query showed distributions, column quality, data types, blanks, and potential errors before dashboarding. That supports repeatable accounting analysis.

Accounting fit

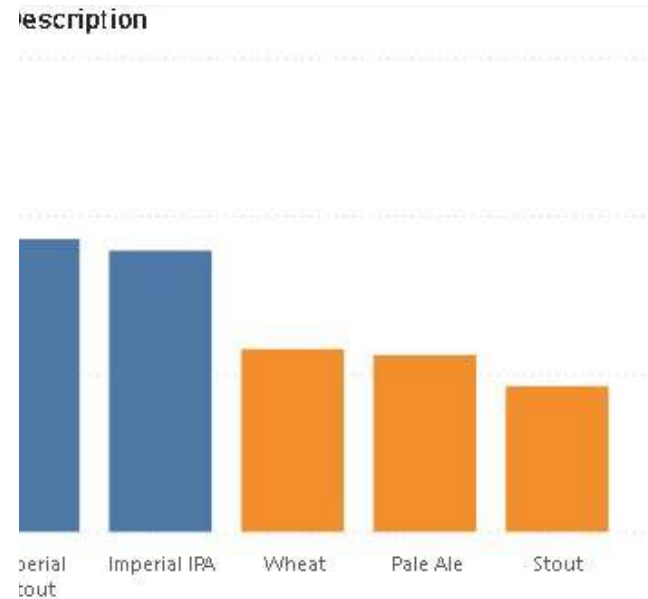
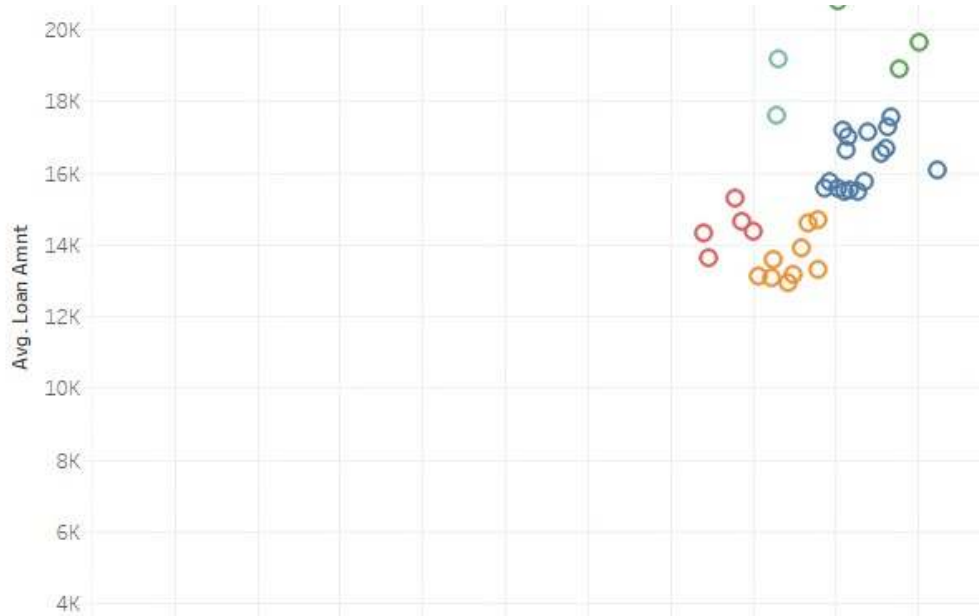
The same workflow supports duplicate-payment testing, anomaly review, variance analysis, and KPI monitoring within the Microsoft ecosystem.

Limitation

The interface and DAX/model setup can feel complex, especially when building custom measures and multi-step dashboards.

Tableau: faster visual exploration

Tableau helped the story become clear for non-technical readers



Visual strength

Clusters, maps, bars, and scatter plots made patterns easier to see quickly.

Storytelling strength

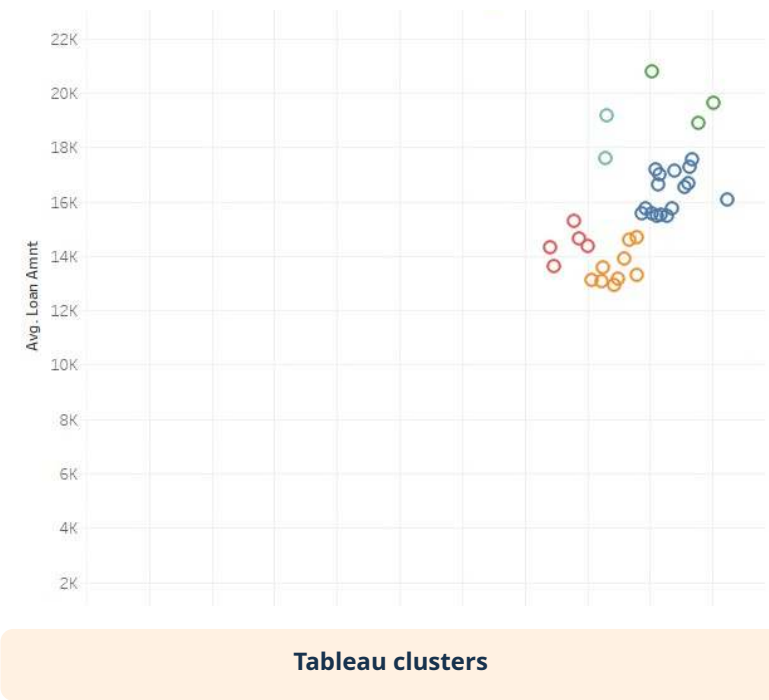
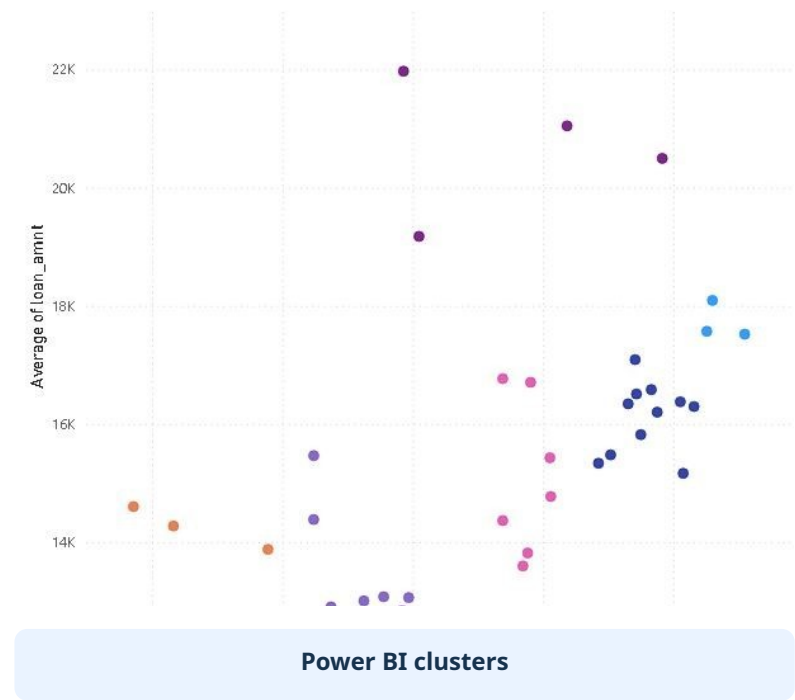
The KPI dashboard clearly shows product profitability, regional delivery patterns, sales drivers, and customer behavior.

Best use

Use Tableau when the goal is polished visual exploration or a leadership-facing dashboard.

Anomalies and audit findings

Both tools helped surface exceptions that matter to accounting



it Amount

Payment D..	Duplicate?	Prepared By	In
9/30/2019	Yes	1033	4
11/16/2019	Yes	1033	4

Duplicate payments

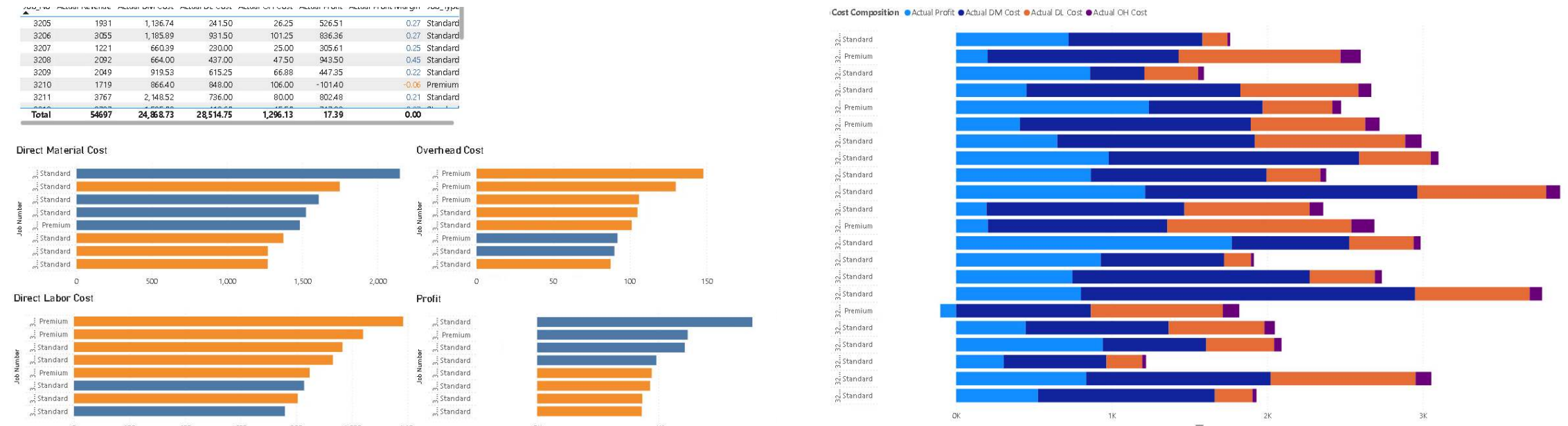
Key finding

Anomalies included extreme income values, outlier borrower clusters, and duplicate-payment indicators. These are not just chart points; they are audit questions.

Source: ACC 430 Labs 3-2 and 6-3 screenshots.

Quantitative methods used

The labs moved beyond visuals into measurable accounting analysis



Methods applied

Descriptive statistics, aggregation, clustering, variance analysis, ratio analysis, duplicate flags, KPI thresholds, and dashboard filtering.

Accounting conclusion

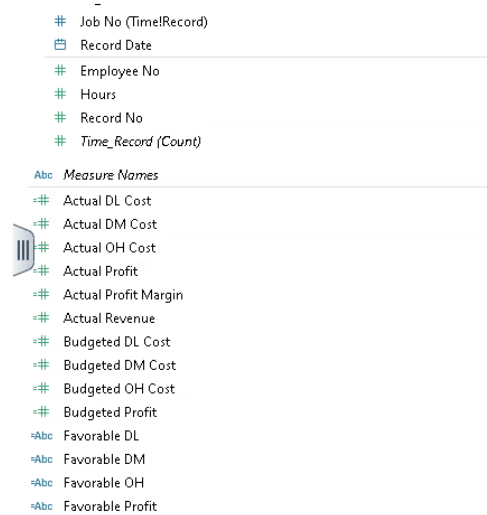
The best tool must support both analysis and follow-up: where costs vary, which jobs underperform, and which KPIs need management action.

Source: ACC 430 Labs 7-1 and 7-2 screenshots; Richardson et al. (2023) data analytics process concepts.

Disadvantages and implementation risks

The recommendation considers tool limitations, not just strengths

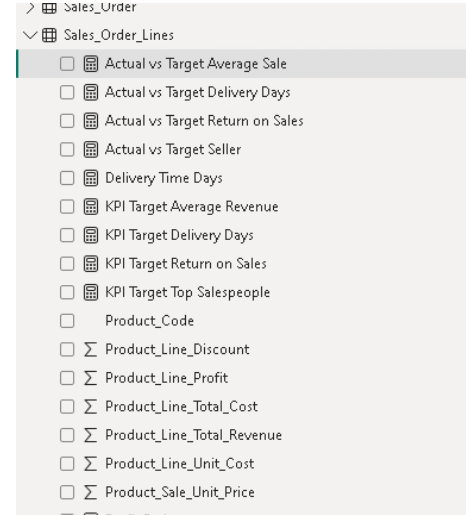
Power BI risks



Learning curve

DAX, relationships, and measure setup can slow adoption. Dashboard layout can also become crowded.

Tableau risks



Governance/publication

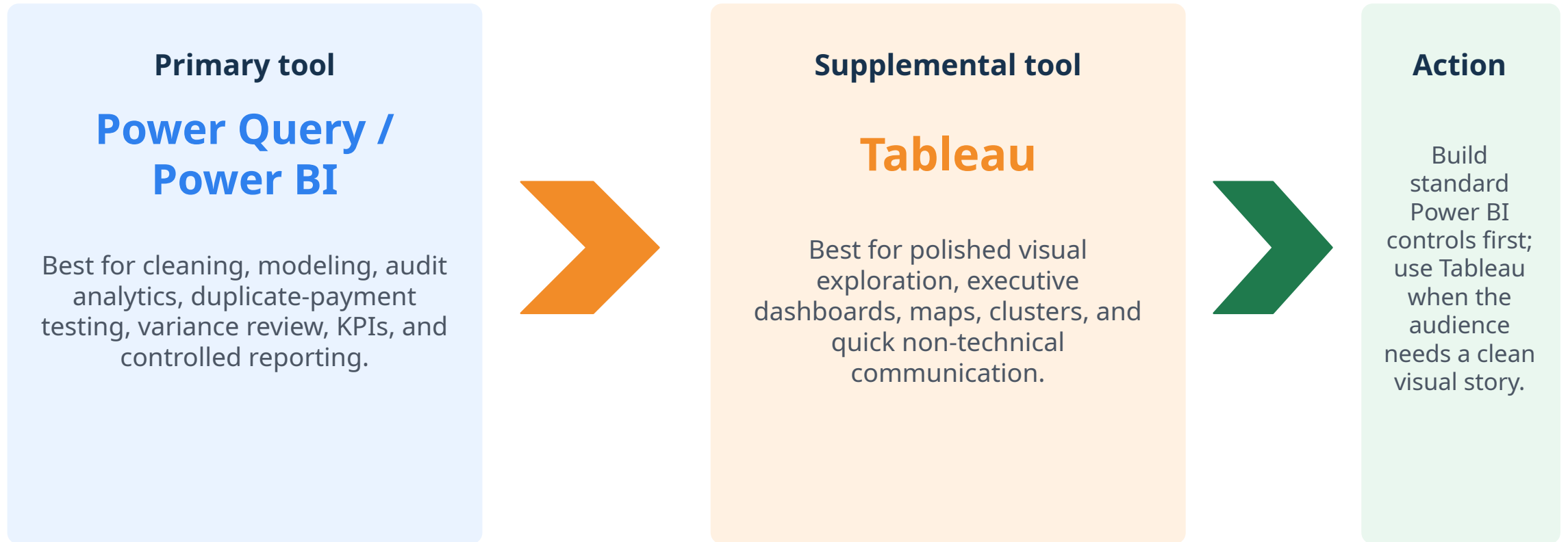
Tableau Public is not appropriate for confidential accounting data. A secure Server/Cloud setup and Tableau Prep workflow would be needed.

Risk response

Train users on Power Query, DAX basics, and dashboard design; restrict access to confidential data; establish standard data-quality checks before publication.

Leadership summary: choose Power BI

Simple recommendation for a non-technical audience



Leadership version: simple and direct, focused on what tool to use and why.

References and recording note

Speaker notes are included for OBS/Bongo narration

References

Microsoft. (2026). Introduction to dashboards for Power BI designers. Microsoft Learn.

Microsoft. (2026). Visualizations in Power BI. Microsoft Learn.

Richardson, V. J., Teeter, R. A., & Terrell, K. L. (2023). Data analytics for accounting. McGraw Hill.

Tableau. (2026). Save workbooks to Tableau Public. Tableau Help.

Tableau. (2026). What is Tableau? Tableau.

Vora, S. (2019). The power of data storytelling. Sage Publications.

OBS recording plan

Use Presenter View or open the speaker-notes PDF while recording. Keep the narration around 6 to 8 minutes: one clear point per slide.

Closing line

Based on the analysis, Power BI should be adopted as the department's primary accounting analytics platform.